

PearDip Tea

A teabag shaped like a pear — the product is the marketing.

What It Is

A novelty tea brand selling teabags molded into playful shapes — pears, fruits, animals — that brew exactly like normal bags. The tea is ordinary quality; the design is the whole point. Gen Z buys and posts unexpected, cute products, so each customer who shares a photo advertises for you for free.

How It Makes Money

Direct-to-consumer e-commerce: you sell boxed sets of shaped teabags at a premium gift price, with the playful design driving organic reach and repeat gifting. Revenue from single boxes, multi-shape gift bundles, subscriptions, and wholesale to gift shops, cafés, and boutiques.

Startup Costs

- Custom shaped-teabag manufacturing (Alibaba: "novelty shaped tea bag custom" / "fruit shape tea bag"): MOQ typically 1,000–3,000 units
- Per-unit production cost: \$0.25–\$0.60 per shaped bag at moderate volume (silk/nylon pyramid material + custom mold + tea fill)
- Custom box/packaging: \$0.40–\$1.00 per retail box (Alibaba: "custom tea box packaging")
- One-time mold/tooling fee for a custom shape: \$300–\$900
- Sea freight + duty on first order: \$400–\$900
- Branding, Shopify store, photography: \$600–\$1,500
- First-month ads/influencer seeding: \$800–\$2,000
- **Total to launch: \$3,000–\$7,000**

The Numbers

- Landed cost per retail box (say 6 shaped bags + box): ~\$2.80–\$4.50
- Sell price: \$14–\$22 per box
- Profit per box: \$10–\$18
- Wholesale price to shops: \$7–\$9 (still ~\$4 profit)
- Sell 800–1,500 boxes/month across DTC + wholesale = **\$9,000–\$22,000 revenue, \$7,000–\$16,000 profit/month**, with viral spikes when a post lands.

How To Start

1. Pick one hero shape (pear is proven) and source 2–3 Alibaba manufacturers who make custom-molded teabags; order samples.
2. Choose a decent but affordable tea blend and a food-safe biodegradable bag material.
3. Pay the one-time mold fee and place a first run of 1,500–3,000 bags in your best shape.
4. Design giftable packaging that photographs well — the box is part of the product.
5. Build a Shopify store with strong lifestyle/close-up photography and a clear gift angle.

6. Seed 30–50 micro-influencers and aesthetic/foodie TikTok accounts with free boxes.
7. Add a wholesale line sheet and pitch gift shops, bookstores, and cafés.

Where To Get Customers

TikTok and Instagram (the unboxing/brew reveal is the engine); Etsy and Amazon Handmade for gift buyers; wholesale to boutiques, cafés, and museum/gift shops via Faire; seasonal gift-guide features; Pinterest for "cute gift" searches.

Pro Tips

- The shape is the ad budget — pick something instantly recognizable and screenshot-worthy, because boring shapes kill the entire free-marketing flywheel.
- Use biodegradable/plastic-free bag material and say so loudly; it removes the one objection thoughtful gift buyers have about novelty tea.
- Launch a second and third shape on a schedule to drive "collect them all" repeat purchases and keep the content fresh.